Nationwide Paid Sick Leave Policy

Policy No. HR-204. Owner: Benefits and Absence Management. Applies to all U.S. colleagues who are not enrolled in the Flexible PTO program.

1. Purpose

Meridian Financial Group provides Paid Sick Leave (PSL) so that colleagues can take time away from work for their own health, to care for a family member, or for the safety reasons described in Section 6 without a loss of pay. This policy states the nationwide minimum. Where a state or city requires something different, the state-specific language in Section 7 controls for colleagues working in that location.

2. Scope and Eligibility

All regular full-time, part-time, and temporary U.S. colleagues who are classified as PTO-ineligible begin accruing PSL on their first day of employment. Colleagues enrolled in Flexible PTO are covered by policy HR-210 instead and should not use this document to determine an entitlement. Interns and contingent workers engaged through a staffing supplier are covered by the supplier's own program.

Eligibility to use PSL is not the same as eligibility for a leave of absence. A continuous absence of more than five consecutive scheduled workdays is administered as a leave of absence under HR-301 and is coordinated with any available PSL.

3. Accrual

Colleagues accrue one (1) hour of PSL for every thirty (30) hours worked. Accrual is calculated on actual hours worked and does not include hours already paid as PSL, holiday, or bereavement time. Partial accrual blocks carry forward to the next pay period and are not rounded up.

Item	Nationwide standard
Accrual rate	1 hour per 30 hours worked
Maximum annual accrual	56 hours
Maximum annual use	56 hours
Year-end carryover cap	40 hours
Waiting period before first use	None

4. Carryover and Payout

Unused PSL of up to forty (40) hours carries over into the following calendar year. Carried-over hours count against the 56-hour annual use maximum; they do not create an additional bank. PSL has no cash value and is not paid out at termination unless a state listed in Section 7 requires payout.

Fictional sample content created for a search demo. Not a real policy.

5. Requesting Time and Notice

For a foreseeable absence such as a scheduled medical appointment, request PSL in Workday at least seven (7) calendar days in advance. For an unforeseeable absence, notify your manager as soon as practicable, ordinarily before the start of the scheduled shift, using the call-in method your business area has published.

Meridian may request reasonable documentation when PSL is used for more than three (3) consecutive scheduled workdays. Managers must not ask for a diagnosis and must not retain medical records in a team or departmental file. Documentation goes directly to the Absence Management team at the address printed on the request form.

> Managers: do not record the reason for a sick absence in Workday comments, email, or a performance note. Record only that approved PSL was taken.

6. Permitted Uses

1. The colleague's own mental or physical illness, injury, health condition, preventive care, or diagnosis.
2. Care for a family member with an illness, injury, health condition, preventive care, or diagnosis. Family member means a child, parent, spouse, domestic partner, grandparent, grandchild, or sibling, including step and in-law relationships.
3. Closure of the colleague's workplace, or of a child's school or place of care, by order of a public official for a public health reason.
4. Safe time: absence related to domestic violence, sexual assault, or stalking affecting the colleague or a family member, including obtaining services or relocating.

7. State-Specific Requirements

The following provisions replace or supplement the nationwide standard for colleagues whose recorded work location is in the state or city named. Provisions that are not expressly changed below continue to apply.

Colorado

Colorado colleagues accrue and use PSL on the nationwide schedule. In addition, when a public health emergency is declared, Meridian provides a one-time supplemental grant of forty-eight (48) hours that may be used for the emergency-related reasons set out in the declaration. The supplemental grant is separate from the 56-hour annual maximum and expires four weeks after the declaration ends.

Maine

Maine colleagues may use the first twenty-four (24) hours of accrued leave in a calendar year for any reason, including vacation and personal time, and not only for the purposes listed in Section 6. After the first 24 hours, remaining accrued leave may be used only for the Section 6 purposes. Maine colleagues must give four (4) weeks of notice for leave that is not an emergency.

New York State

New York colleagues may use up to fifty-six (56) hours of PSL per calendar year. Meridian does not require documentation for an absence of fewer than three consecutive workdays and does not require a colleague to

Fictional sample content created for a search demo. Not a real policy.

find a replacement worker as a condition of using leave.

New York City

In addition to the New York State provisions, New York City colleagues may use PSL as safe time under the Earned Safe and Sick Time Act for any purpose permitted by that act. A colleague may designate any individual whose close association is the equivalent of a family relationship as a covered family member once per calendar year.

Philadelphia, Pennsylvania

A colleague who works in Philadelphia and believes PSL was denied, or that they were retaliated against for requesting or taking PSL, may file a complaint with the city agency within one hundred eighty (180) days of the alleged violation. This right is in addition to the internal reporting channels in Section 8.

Seattle, Washington

Meridian is a Tier 3 employer for purposes of the Seattle Paid Sick and Safe Time Ordinance. Seattle colleagues accrue one hour per thirty hours worked and may carry over up to one hundred eight (108) hours at year end, which is higher than the nationwide cap. For safe-time absences, household member includes a spouse, domestic partner, former spouse, and any individual with whom the colleague shares a residence.

Fictional sample content created for a search demo. Not a real policy.

8. Non-Retaliation

Meridian strictly prohibits retaliation or discrimination against any colleague for requesting or using PSL, or for reporting a suspected violation of this policy. Colleagues who believe they have been retaliated against should contact their manager, an Employee Relations Partner, or the Ethics Helpline, which is available at all hours and accepts anonymous reports where local law permits.

9. Related Documents

- HR-210 Flexible Paid Time Off Policy
- HR-301 Leave of Absence Policy
- HR-118 Colleague Privacy Notice
- People Central article KB0011204, How to request a leave of absence

10. Revision History

Revision	Date	Summary
4.0	January 1, 2026	Added the Philadelphia complaint window; refreshed all state supplements.
3.0	January 1, 2025	Added Seattle Tier 3 designation and 108-hour carryover.
2.1	July 15, 2024	Clarified documentation threshold at three consecutive days.
2.0	January 1, 2024	Added safe-time uses and New York City designation.

Fictional sample content created for a search demo. Not a real policy.